

USMAN IBRAHIM

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SUMMARY

Cyber Security student with hands-on security engineering and SOC experience. At NetraLink, architected the threat intelligence pipeline for a 15-microservice DNS security platform and closed an API Gateway auth bypass. At ITSOLERA, deployed a Wazuh SIEM end-to-end (9/9 objectives complete) and built the automation that turns raw alerts into IOC-enriched, NIST-aligned incident reports. Runs a personal SOC lab (Wazuh + ELK) to rehearse attacks before they show up for real. Ready to bring that same range to a SOC Analyst, DFIR, or AppSec internship.

EXPERIENCE

Jul 2026 - Aug 2026
Remote

NetraLink Solutions, Security Engineering Intern

- Architected the threat intelligence ingestion pipeline for DeWall, a 15-microservice enterprise DNS security platform, integrating 5 external feeds (Abuse.ch, PhishTank, URLhaus, AlienVault OTX, Spamhaus) for real-time IOC ingestion; designed DGA and Newly Registered Domain detection models to proactively block C2 and phishing infrastructure, and implemented foundational DNSSEC/RPZ architecture for secure DNS resolution.
- Identified a critical header-spoofing vulnerability in the API Gateway via a security architecture review and remediated it with strict JWT validation and secure server-side extraction of the X-User-Id header, closing an authentication bypass path.
- Standardized authentication across the microservices layer, migrating 7+ critical endpoints to JWT middleware verification, and hardened CI/CD by repairing GitHub Actions security workflows and fixing gosec SAST configurations to block vulnerable code merges.

Jul 2026 - Aug 2026
Remote

ITSOLERA, SOC Team Intern

- SIEM & Detection: Deployed a Wazuh SIEM across Windows and Linux agents (9/9 objectives complete) plus an ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Kibana, Fleet) for centralized log monitoring, integrating Sysmon, Windows Defender, File Integrity Monitoring, and custom XML/YARA detection rules.
- Threat Intel & Automation: Built a Python tool to extract and enrich IOCs via the VirusTotal and AbuseIPDB APIs plus custom CDB threat-intel lists, cutting manual lookup time by 90%+; automated the detection-to-notification pipeline by connecting Wazuh to n8n for real-time incident email alerts.
- DFIR & Network Security: Deployed pfSense with network segmentation and Syslog forwarding to Wazuh, and investigated a live Lumma Stealer infection via Wireshark PCAP analysis, extracting C2 infrastructure and producing a NIST-aligned five-phase incident response plan.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Intellema, Business Development Executive (Technical & Client-Facing) | May 2026 - Aug 2026, Islamabad

Ran the full B2B sales cycle for enterprise AI solutions, writing technical proposals and system architecture diagrams; built a 14-architecture playbook from verified case studies.

Tech Hierarchy, SOC Analyst Intern | Mar 2026, Remote

Triaged 30+ daily alerts in Wazuh/Splunk against MITRE ATT&CK; independently deployed a personal SOC lab (Wazuh + ELK) simulating lateral movement, privilege escalation, and credential dumping.

NASCON 2026 Forensics Arena & RDX National CTF, Challenge Author | Feb 2026 - Aug 2026, FAST NUCES

Designed "Silent Harvest," a memory forensics challenge (MITRE T1003.001, Volatility 3, NTLM hash extraction), plus 6 more RDX challenges (100+ participants combined).

EDUCATION

Aug 2024 - Jun 2028

FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, BS Cyber Security

- Relevant coursework: Software Engineering, Cybersecurity-I, Computer Networks.
- Cyber Space Legion (University Cybersecurity Society): Head of Finance (Sept 2025-Present) and Technical Team Member (Sept 2024-Present).

PROJECTS

PIMS - POS Inventory Management System | Next.js, Supabase, TypeScript

Engineered a granular RBAC system across three layers plus PostgreSQL Row Level Security for tenant isolation; eliminated SQLi/XSS vectors with Zod validation and hardened sessions with strict JWTs and CSP/HSTS headers.

NextGen Residency - Smart Housing Platform | MongoDB, Express.js, React

Hardened backend API with Helmet.js headers, CSRF protection, and NoSQL injection prevention; integrated TOTP-based 2FA and JWT refresh tokens.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA) - HTB (In Progress)

Network Security - Cisco

Security Operations Center (SOC) - Cisco

ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Information Security Associate - SkillFront

Computer Networks and Network Security - IBM

SKILLS

SOC & DFIR: Alert Triage, Incident Response (NIST Lifecycle), Threat Hunting, Malware Analysis, Memory Forensics (Volatility 3), MITRE ATT&CK
SIEM & Detection Engineering: Wazuh, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, Fleet), Sysmon, Windows Defender, FIM, Custom XML/YARA Rules
Threat Intel & Automation: VirusTotal API, AbuseIPDB API, IOC Extraction, CDB Lists, n8n (SOAR), Webhooks, JSON Parsing, Python (Regex), PowerShell
AppSec & DevSecOps: JWT Middleware, API Gateway Hardening, RBAC, IAM, Secrets Management, GitHub Actions, gosec (SAST)
Network Security: pfSense, Network Segmentation, Geo-blocking, Syslog, Wireshark, PCAP Analysis, DNSSEC/RPZ, OSPF, ACLs
Achievements: 3rd Place, SudoFuzzers CTF (top 6% of 50+ teams); 7th Place, CyberFest 2025 (top 7%); Star of CyberFest '25